

**Board Memo**

TO: CARE Foundation and Prof. Kathy Kretman

FROM: Anurita Srivastava and Danlei Liao, Program Officers

SUBJECT: Thelma D. Jones Breast Cancer Fund, Grant Proposal

DATE: April 5, 2025

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The Thelma D. Jones Breast Cancer Fund (TDJBCF) is a distinctive nonprofit grassroots organization dedicated to enhancing women's and men's health and wellness through targeted outreach, education, and prevention initiatives. Founded in April 2010 as the TDJBCF Support Group, which was modeled after the World Bank Group-IMF Support Group, the support group evolved into the TDJBCF in September 2012 in honor of Jones' 60th birthday; the organization was subsequently established in 2018 as a 501(c)(3) nonprofit to expand the impact of her advocacy efforts<sup>1</sup>. The Fund emphasizes early detection strategies and aims to reduce the incidence and mortality rates associated with breast cancer, particularly within historically underserved communities.

**Grant Purpose**

We live in a moment marked by profound uncertainty and upheaval across our nation, especially within the communities of our nation's capital. The nonprofit sector is crucial in holding people together in Washington, D.C., where long-standing disparities intersect with ongoing public health, economic, and racial justice challenges. The TDJBCF stands out as a beacon of resilience, compassion, and purpose. There is no better timing to recognize and uplift organizations like TDJBCF, those that keep showing up for their communities, grounded in the belief that their work matters and their people deserve better.

The TDJBCF seeks a \$10,000 grant to support its rebranding, communication, and outreach initiatives. These are tools that are vital for amplifying the voices of breast cancer patients and survivors, particularly in historically underserved communities. In a landscape where visibility often dictates survival, this grant would enable TDJBCF to tell its story and the stories of the people it serves, which are usually missing or undervalued in mainstream narratives. These efforts would ensure that people who face multiple players of marginalization are seen, heard, and, most importantly, supported. Investing in TDJBCF is investing in a life-affirming belief that no one should face breast cancer alone.

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<sup>1</sup> Thelma D. Jones Breast Cancer Fund. (2021, May 1). <https://tdjbreastcancerfund.org/about-us/>

Breast cancer survivors often endure compounded struggles such as financial instability, transportation barriers, mental health challenges, domestic violence, caregiving responsibilities, and social stigma. Misconceptions about breast cancer, including myths about treatment, biases in pain perception, and cultural taboos, further discourage open discussion and early intervention. A robust communication strategy will not only increase breast health literacy but also ensure that survivors from diverse backgrounds, including LGBTQ+ individuals and communities of color, feel seen and supported.

Funding will be allocated toward branding and communications materials, including the design and printing of informational fact sheets, resource documents, brochures, branded collateral, and social media content creation. These materials will highlight TDJBCF's programs and services while providing accessible, culturally relevant breast cancer education. Additionally, new materials will be developed to enhance TDJBCF's visibility at public events, especially tabling.

Funding will also support the production of short videos and other media assets to strengthen social media engagement, produce visually compelling digital content, and enhance multimedia storytelling and outreach capacity. Dedicated staff support will be provided for a social media coordinator and a graphic designer to develop high-quality digital content.

If additional funds remain, they will be used for website updates and fundraising efforts, further expanding TDJBCF's digital presence and accessibility.

### **Benefit to the Organization and Community**

This grant will allow TDJBCF to establish a stronger, more cohesive brand identity that effectively communicates its mission, services, and the realities breast cancer survivors face in underserved communities. By improving public outreach, educational messaging, and survivor storytelling, this initiative will increase engagement with individuals who might otherwise lack access to critical breast health information.

This grant will strengthen TDJBCF's presence at community events and leverage social media platforms, further broadening the organization's reach and fostering strong connections with healthcare providers, advocacy groups, and potential donors. Additionally, a more robust and professional branding strategy will enhance TDJBCF's fundraising potential, ensuring the organization's long-term sustainability in providing essential services to the community. Overall, this will also help to create greater trust within marginalized communities.

Breast cancer remains the most commonly diagnosed cancer in Washington, D.C., the third leading cause of cancer-related death<sup>2</sup>. While 1 in 8 women nationwide will face a breast cancer diagnosis in their lifetime<sup>3</sup>, Black women in D.C. face significantly worse outcomes. Despite having slightly lower incidence rates nationally, Black women in the District experience a higher

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<sup>2</sup> *About breast cancer* | Howard University Hospital | Washington, D.C. (n.d.). (C)1998-2025 Geonetric. All Rights Reserved. <https://www.huhealthcare.com/health-services/radiology/womens-imaging/breast-cancer>

<sup>3</sup> Team, N. (2025, April 2). *Breast Cancer Facts & Stats 2024 - Incidence, age, survival, & more*. National Breast Cancer Foundation. <https://www.nationalbreastcancer.org/breast-cancer-facts>

incidence rate (139.4 per 100,000) than White women (128.5 per 100,000) and are twice as likely to die from the disease, with a mortality rate of 33.2 per 100,000. In Ward 6, where TDJBCF is based, over 30% of residents are Black, and approximately half of that subgroup are women. This community faces a disproportionate risk that is further compounded by systemic barriers such as healthcare bias, low health literacy, stigma, financial instability, and caregiving burdens. These disparities make culturally tailored outreach, survivor storytelling, and equitable education efforts timely and essential.

In this context, the proposed grant will better equip TDJBCF to challenge misinformation, dismantle stigma, and connect women of color to life-saving resources. Improved communication outcomes will reach women navigating multiple social roles, many are caring for children, elderly parents, or working multiple jobs, by making breast health information more relatable, accessible, and actionable. Survivors facing transportation limitations or financial hardship will encounter fewer barriers to accessing support. The initiative will foster greater trust, engagement, and awareness to advance breast health equity across Ward 6 and beyond.

### **Impact Measurement**

TDJBCF will assess the effectiveness of this initiative through the following metrics-

#### *Branding and Outreach Effectiveness*

- Track the number of brochures, fact sheets, and branding materials distributed;
- Measure attendance and engagement at tabling events and community health fairs;
- Assess new survivor, caregiver, and partner engagement driven by the new branding materials.

#### *Social Media and Digital Engagement*

- Monitor social media growth (new followers, likes, shares, and comments).
- Evaluate post reach, impressions, and engagement rates.
- Track website traffic and user engagement, including time spent on educational resources.

#### *Community Impact*

- Conduct pre- and post-engagement surveys to evaluate breast cancer awareness and changes in misconceptions.
- Track new survivor participation in TDJBCF's support programs following outreach efforts.
- Collect survivor testimonials to document the impact of enhanced communication and outreach.

#### *Organizational Growth and Fundraising Success*

- Measure increases in donor engagement and new funding opportunities.
- Track growth in grant applications, corporate sponsorships, and volunteer recruitment.
- Evaluate the success of digital fundraising efforts tied to the updated branding strategy.

## Reporting and Impact Communication

Results will be shared through quarterly grant reports, public engagement updates, and an annual impact summary. Regular reports to the Board Members will provide quantitative data on branding material distribution, social media engagement, and outreach expansion, supplemented by survivor impact stories. Updates will be disseminated via TDJBCF's social media, website, and newsletters, highlighting key achievements such as successful outreach events, survivor testimonials, and increased community participation. The Annual Impact Report will summarize the initiative's success, demonstrating how improved branding and storytelling efforts have expanded awareness, empowered survivors, and strengthened TDJBCF's ability to reach and support historically underserved communities.

## Proposed Budget

| Item                                                | Price    | Quantity                 | Total   |
|-----------------------------------------------------|----------|--------------------------|---------|
|                                                     |          |                          |         |
| Brochure Printing (trifold)                         | \$5.4    | 500                      | \$2,700 |
| Pins                                                | \$4      | 200                      | \$800   |
| One-Pagers for color front and back (8.5 x 11)      | \$2      | 500                      | \$1,000 |
| Display Materials for Community Events 8 x 8 Banner | \$300    | 1                        | \$300   |
| Labor                                               | Per Hour | Number of Hours Per Week | Total   |
| Social Media Coordinator                            | \$50     | 20                       | \$1,000 |
| Website Update & Maintenance                        | \$150    | 10                       | \$1,500 |

|                                         |       |    |                |
|-----------------------------------------|-------|----|----------------|
| Fundraising & Digital Marketing Support | \$150 | 15 | \$2,250        |
|                                         |       |    | <b>\$9,250</b> |

## Organization Information

### Mission and History

Thelma's advocacy journey began following her diagnosis. Drawing from her experiences navigating the healthcare system, she recognized the critical need for patient support and education, particularly in marginalized communities. Inspired by the support group model at the World Bank Group, where she found strength and encouragement, she established TDJBCF to extend these resources to a broader audience<sup>4</sup>. TDJBCF is supported by seven ambassadors and a dedicated Board of Directors of healthcare professionals, community leaders, survivors, and advocates committed to advancing the organization's mission. The board provides strategic oversight, ensures financial sustainability, and strengthens partnerships that enhance TDJBCF's reach and impact.

*"Our vision is to save lives and embrace and achieve a world community free of breast cancer. We plan to realize this vision with guiding principles of respect, collaboration, quality and patient-centred care, culturally sensitive approaches, and evidence-based strategies."*<sup>5</sup>

### Community Impact

TDJBCF actively engages in policy advocacy, healthcare access initiatives, and direct community outreach. Key contributions include:

- Advocacy efforts lead to increased funding for breast and cervical cancer programs;
- Stronger tobacco control policies through legislative collaborations;
- Monthly breast cancer support group meetings in DC, providing emotional and educational support to survivors and caregivers;
- Public health education initiatives targeting historically underserved communities.

### Population Served

TDJBCF primarily serves the Washington, DC Metropolitan Area, including Northern Virginia and Maryland, with an estimated reach of 72,000 individuals through support groups, outreach events, newsletters, and survivor navigation. The demographic breakdown includes-

- **Geographic Reach:** 50% in Southwest DC, 30% in DC, and 20% in Maryland;

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<sup>4</sup> Ms. Thelma D. Jones: *Model, Spirit of Volunteerism*. (n.d.). World Bank. <https://www.worldbank.org/en/exhibits/Thelma-D-Jones>

<sup>5</sup> Thelma D. Jones Breast Cancer Fund. (2021, May 1). <https://tdjbreastcancerfund.org/about-us/vision>

- **Age Range:** 30-95 years old, with an average of 60-70 due to participation in the food program;
- **Ethnicity:** 55% African American (inc. the Diaspora), 20% White, 10% Asian, 10% Latino, and 5% Eastern European.

TDJBCF also emphasizes male participation in breast cancer awareness and survivor support. For more than seven years, the organization's February Black History meeting has been dedicated to raising awareness about breast cancer in men, men's health, and behavioral health<sup>6</sup>. Additionally, TDJBCF collaborates with a male breast cancer survivor based in Las Vegas to further promote education and advocacy efforts.

### **Core Programs and Services**

- TDJBCF Breast Cancer Support Group: A nationally recognized initiative supporting over 1,000 survivors, caregivers, and advocates since 2010;
- Education and Outreach: Workshops, panel discussions, and community events provide breast health education to underserved populations, including public housing communities, faith-based organizations, and schools;
- Screening and Early Detection: Partnerships with health and screening providers helps offer free or low-cost mammograms and patient navigation services;
- Awareness Campaigns: Participation in events like Making Strides Against Breast Cancer & Relay for Life to mobilize community support;
- Communication and Information Sharing: The "Upcoming Events" e-blast reaches over 1,200 subscribers and 4,000 secondary readers with updates on health initiatives and survivor resources;
- Financial Assistance: Limited support is available for utilities, transportation to medical appointments, and bereavement needs;
- Policy Advocacy: Lobbying with healthcare professionals, policymakers, and research institutions advances equitable healthcare policies;
- Survivor Empowerment: Ensuring survivors can access support and long-term resources through mentorship and advocacy programs.

### **Conclusion**

At TDJBCF, we believe that no one should face breast cancer alone. This grant will allow us to strengthen our outreach, provide critical education, bridge gaps in healthcare access and ensure that all survivors, regardless of background, receive the support they deserve. As Thelma D. Jones once said, *"It's not just about surviving breast cancer—it's about thriving beyond it!"*

We appreciate your consideration of our proposal and the opportunity to expand TDJBCF's impact.

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<sup>6</sup> Jr, S. (2025, February 24). *Annual Black History Month Celebration Support Group Meeting | Breast Cancer in Men*. <https://tdjbreastcancerfund.org/annual>